Questions to Ask at an Eligibility Meeting

Before a decision is made, know what to ask.

Eligibility meetings are high stakes. The team is deciding whether your child qualifies for special education services under IDEA. These questions help you understand the process, the data, and your rights before you leave that room.

1. **How did my input as a parent factor into this decision?**
Your observations at home are part of the evaluation data. Ask specifically how what you shared was considered, not just whether it was received.

2. **Did this evaluation look at how my child is functioning across different settings, not just one classroom?**
A complete picture of your child should include input from multiple environments. How your child performs in one setting does not always reflect the full impact of their needs.

3. **Did all members of the evaluation team agree on this determination?**
Eligibility decisions should reflect team consensus. If there was disagreement within the team, you are entitled to know that.

4. **What do the scores and findings actually mean for my child's day-to-day experience at school?**
Numbers and categories matter less than what they mean in practice. Ask the team to connect the evaluation findings to what your child actually experiences in the classroom.

5. **If my child is found ineligible, what supports are still available to them at school?**
Ineligibility does not mean your child gets nothing. General education supports, a 504 plan, or RTI services may still be options. Ask what is available.

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6 **If my child is found eligible, how will the IEP be developed and who will be involved?**
Eligibility is the beginning of the process. Ask who will be on the IEP team, when the first meeting will be scheduled, and what your role will be.

7 **Who else should receive or be made aware of the information from this evaluation?**
The findings from this evaluation may be relevant beyond the school setting. Your child's pediatrician, private providers, or other support people in your child's life may benefit from having this information. Ask the team who they would recommend sharing it with.

8 **If I disagree with this evaluation, what are my options?**
You have the right to put your disagreement in writing and request reconsideration. Mediation is also available before escalating further. If you believe an independent evaluation is warranted, you are entitled to request one at the district's expense. Ask the team to explain that process before you leave.

9 **What would need to look different for my child's eligibility status to be reconsidered in the future?**
Circumstances change. Whether your child is found eligible or not today, ask what would warrant a reevaluation and how that process gets started.

10 **Am I required to sign anything today, and what am I agreeing to if I do?**
Know exactly what your signature means before you put it on anything. You are allowed to take documents home to review before signing.

Still processing what was decided at the meeting? We can help you understand what it means and what comes next.

Book a free 15-minute consultation at
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